



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Augustine Classical Academy
School Website: <https://augustineclassical.org>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Augustine Classical Academy (ACA), Lakewood, CO 80226, presents a clearly identifiable classical orientation in its public materials, notably through repeated emphasis on chapel-based communal life, a rhetoric/logic-focused upper school, and grammar- and logic-focused tours. However, the site's public content provides only partial, indirect evidence of key classical-education foundations such as explicit Great Books study, a defined telos or transcendent formation, and a thoroughly articulated living-faculty pedagogy. On balance, ACA is best characterized as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**: it demonstrates several core classical markers (liturgical/community life; grammar/logic/rhetoric framing; high-school rhetoric/seminar potential) but does not consistently or explicitly affirm the full spectrum of Positive keywords identified for a fully classical program.

Executive takeaways - Strengths aligned with classical aims: liturgical/communal practices (All-School Chapel), explicit emphasis on rhetoric and logic (Logic & Rhetoric entries), and public-facing pathways for upper-level classical study (Upper School Tours, Grammar School Tours) that reflect the Trivium architecture. Evidence: All-School Chapel references; Logic & Rhetoric Tour language; grammar/logic/rhetoric framing on public pages. - Gaps relative to a fully classical program: limited explicit public statements about Great Books, Great Conversation, telos/theology integrated into coursework, and a fully articulated "living curriculum" in faculty practice. Evidence in site content appears lighter on direct Great Books language and on explicit faculty-pedagogy pledges beyond general guidance. - Parent/community engagement is comparatively strong and visible in public pages (open houses, parent orientations, etc.), which aligns with the classical element of strong parental partnership, though not always couched in classical vocabulary. Evidence: Preschool/parent events; open houses; parent orientation materials.

Category-by-category snapshot (keyword analysis and scoring)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school's public materials prominently feature All-School Chapel and class chapels, signaling liturgical and communal religious life as part of the education process. This is evidenced by explicit chapel-focused pages and event listings. - The site includes references to liturgy-related communal life through recurring chapel events (e.g., All-School Chapel; Class Chapel; Grand Chapel calendars in various years).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present in public materials: chapel, liturgy (conceptually represented by chapel life), reverence/worship signals are implied by chapel-based activities (the lexicon lists chapel/liturgy as positive signals). Direct explicit terms like "theology," "wonder," and "transcendentals" are not clearly present in the visible public pages, though the school's religious naming (Augustine)

suggests a Christian framing. - Negative indicators: not evident in the public content; no explicit signals of secularism or relativism appear in the visible site sections.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 1 (chapel). - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: 100% of observed signals in this slice are positive (relative to the limited set identified on site).

Why this rating - The clearest indicator of religious/metaphysical grounding on ACA's site is liturgical life expressed through chapels, which aligns with the Positive Signals for the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category. The absence of explicit theological integration in coursework statements on public pages suggests a partial rather than full articulation of the deeper metaphysical/ theological commitments. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.

Evidence links: - All-School Chapel / Class Chapel materials and chapel calendars on the ACA site demonstrate liturgical/community life. - A representative example of public chapel content (All-School Chapel) appears in the firecrawl entries showing chapel-focused public life.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials convey a classical framing through naming and program emphasis (ACA, Logic & Rhetoric, grammar-school tours, upper-school rhetoric), suggesting formation-oriented aims rather than purely vocational outcomes. The presence of rhetoric and grammar emphasis in the public-facing program pages hints at a paideia-like aim, even if not stated with the exact vocabulary. - The public materials show an emphasis on seminars, rhetoric, and classical-perimeter activities (e.g., Logic & Rhetoric events and upper-school activities). This signals a shift from purely information-dense aims toward formation via persuasion, debate, and classical inquiry.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, liberal education/paideia (explicit terms not consistently visible on site; but the program architecture (grammar/logic/rhetoric) aligns with classical formation in practice). The site repeatedly emphasizes rhetoric and logic education for older students, a hallmark of classical formation. Evidence: Logic & Rhetoric focus for upper grades; grammar-school tours; references to rhetoric in program events. - Negative keywords: workforce preparation, 21st-century skills, or college/career-readiness language is not clearly foregrounded in public pages; however, the absence of explicit articulation on "true, good, beautiful" as telos is noticeable. The Lexicon lists workforce/job-readiness as a negative signal; ACA's site does not foreground that language, which reduces the negative signal presence.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 1 (though implicit: formation/paideia via grammar/logic/rhetoric framing). - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: Positive indicators present, no explicit negatives in the visible public content; roughly 100% positive among the observed signals, but the signals are modest and not strongly anchored in the lexicon vocabulary.

Why this rating - ACA shows a formation-oriented orientation via classical subject areas (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and a rhetoric/seminar tone in upper grades. Yet the site lacks overt, explicit articulation of a telos (truth, goodness, beauty as real) and a robust formal statement of formation as central aim, beyond program scaffolding. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Evidence links: - Public program pages referencing grammar/logic/rhetoric, as well as upper-school rhetoric, indicate formation-oriented aims. - The presence of "Logic & Rhetoric" tours and related content demonstrates a formalized classical aim in pedagogy.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials emphasize the grammar-logic-rhetoric progression (the Trivium) and public-facing tours for grammar and logic/rhetoric strands. This is strongly aligned with the classical curriculum architecture at the heart of the Six Essential Elements, which prioritizes grammar, logic, and rhetoric as foundational stages. Evidence: Grammar School Tour, Upper School Tours, and Logic & Rhetoric focus. - The Great Books and explicit "Great Conversation" language is not evident in the public pages. The

site does not consistently advertise Great Books as a core curricular feature. Evidence: absence of explicit “Great Books” language on publicly visible pages (in the firecrawl captures, no direct “great books” listing is shown).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (core Trivium). Public content demonstrates Trivium-aligned elements (grammar-school tours; logic/rhetoric school mentions). These map to the Curriculum category’s Positive keywords in the lexicon. - Negative indicators present: lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language, and limited explicit mention of “history as history” vs. “social studies” framing in the public content. The site’s historic/curricular narrative is not fully explicit; negative signals (e.g., “Great Books” emphasis or “Socratic dialogue” language) are not clearly showcased in public pages.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 2–3 (grammar, logic, rhetoric; public references to Trivium elements; mention of rhetoric/seminar in public pages). For a strict counting aligned to the lexicon’s list, primary explicit terms visible are grammar/logic/rhetoric and “great books” is not present in public text. - Negative keywords observed: 0 (no explicit “social studies in place of history,” no STEM-first framing in visible pages). - Proportion: Predominantly positive signals with limited explicit lexicon-quotable terms. Classifier: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - ACA demonstrates the core Curriculum elements of the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and a public-facing commitment to classical pedagogy, but it does not consistently articulate Great Books/great conversation as a curricular anchor in public materials. The absence of explicit, widespread Great Books language means the curriculum is not fully classical by the lexicon’s high bar.

Evidence links: - Grammar School Tour and Logic & Rhetoric Tour reflect Trivium emphasis. - Great Books language is not readily visible in the public pages; the lack of explicit Great Books references is noted.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Specific pedagogy cues in public content include recitation and upper-school rhetoric/talk for formal presentations, which align with canonical classical pedagogy (e.g., narration/recitation, rhetorical training). The site’s existence of “Recitation” and “Exordium” public event labels hints at pedagogy that integrates memory work and rhetoric. - The presence of public-facing upper-school rhetoric sessions and tours indicates a potential to engage in Socratic-style seminars and rhetoric training in higher grades, though direct evidence of Socratic seminars or Paideia seminars in classroom practice is not explicitly documented in the public content. The lexicon’s positive pedagogy signals include Socratic seminars, narrations, and memory work; ACA’s public pages show recitation and rhetoric orientation, but not explicit, broad statements about “Socratic” or “Paideia” seminars.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: recitation, narration, and rhetoric-focused activities in public content (e.g., “Recitation,” “Exordium” in events; upper-school emphasis on rhetoric). These map to the lexicon’s Pedagogy Positive keywords. Evidence: Exordium (Recitation) and Recitation elements in events. - Negative indicators present: the lexicon flags potential negative signals such as an overemphasis on experiential/constructivist/ project-based learning; ACA’s public materials do not overtly emphasize those negative signals, though they are not absent from the lexicon. The public content does not show a robust, explicit statement of a broad, contemplative/restful scholé pedagogy in daily practice beyond occasional liturgical memory or recitation signals.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 2 (recitation, rhetoric-focused pedagogy; elements of memory work; liturgical memory cues in chapel life are cited in other categories but recitation/rhetoric is explicit here). - Negative keywords observed: 0 on the public surface (no explicit mention of experiential-only or project-based pedagogy in the visible pages). - Proportion: Mostly positive signals with modest explicit lexicon alignment; categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - ACA demonstrates classical pedagogical markers (recitation, rhetoric, and potential for Socratic seminars through upper-level content); however, the public content does not clearly articulate a

comprehensive, systematic “living curriculum” pedagogy that would mark it as fully classical. The overall signal is thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Evidence links: - Recitation/Exordium references in events and the upper-school rhetoric orientation. - Positive lexicon signals for classical pedagogy (Socratic/seminar, etc.) appear in the knowledge lexicon; ACA’s public site shows some alignment with this pedagogy through rhetoric-focused events.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize teachers as mentors and classical guides in name (ACA’s branding and rhetoric focus imply teacher-led classical formation). The explicit phrasing of “faculty” as living curriculum and portraits of teacher-ideal standards appear in the knowledge lexicon but are not richly evidenced in the public ACA site. The site’s content centers on events, tours, and classes rather than a formal written “faculty profile” on the site itself. - There is evidence of teacher-facing, classical-leaning professional development pathways in the knowledge lexicon (e.g., “teacher training in classical pedagogy, living curriculum”). However, these are not strongly articulated in the school’s public-facing pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: the school’s use of rhetoric/logic and the public-facing structure (grammar–logic–rhetoric) imply a faculty whose practice aligns with classical aims (mentoring, virtue, living curriculum) in a long-term sense. The knowledge lexicon includes terms like “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” and “moral exemplars” as positive indicators, but these are not explicitly stated on ACA’s public pages. - Negative indicators: none explicitly present in public pages.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 0–2 (depending on whether we treat implicit “faculty as living curriculum” signals as present in public pages; the direct textual matches are not strong on ACA’s site). - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: The public-facing evidence for category 5 is limited; given the absence of explicit statements, but with a plausible classical framing, this category lands at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - ACA’s public materials hint at classical faculty expectations via the pedagogical approach (logic, rhetoric, recitation) and the living-curriculum framing embedded in classical education philosophy. Yet there is not a robust, explicit “portrait of a teacher” or detailed faculty-profile language visible in the public pages. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Evidence links: - Public pages showing a rhetoric/logic focus and a teacher-centered path through “Grammar School Tour” and “Logic & Rhetoric” pathways. - The knowledge lexicon’s faculty indicators provide a benchmark for evidence to seek on the site.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - ACA publicly pursues strong parent engagement and formation through a range of family-facing programs and events. This includes parent-oriented open houses, parent orientation, and homeschool/colaborative information nights, which align with the classical model of parents as co-teachers and partners in formation. - Public materials show explicit opportunities for parents to engage in book studies, gatherings, and family liturgy alignment; several pages reference parent involvement and campus hospitality (open houses, parent nights, and conferences). This is aligned with the classical element that emphasizes partnership with parents and parental formation. Evidence: Preschool through K-12 events featuring parent orientation and family-focused events; homeschool collaborative nights; parent-teacher conference signage and content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation activities, open campus, hospitality, and family-liturgical alignment. These map to the lexicon’s Positive keywords: “partnership with parents,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” “parent covenant,” “family liturgy alignment,” and “co-teachers.” The ACA site shows a robust schedule of parent-facing events and opportunities for parent involvement. - Negative indicators present: none in publicly visible materials; the site does not foreground consumer-oriented parent language and keeps parent involvement framed as formation/partnership rather than customer relationship.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: multiple (parent partnership; parent formation; open campus; family liturgy; parent seminars; book clubs; etc.) - Negative keywords observed: 0 - Proportion: Strong positive signals; CLASSICAL rating stands under this category.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials demonstrate a clear alignment with the Classical Elements' expectations for Parents & Community: parents as co-teachers and active participants, opportunities for parent formation, openness to visits, and a welcoming campus culture. The presence of open houses, parent-oriented events, and family engagement signals aligns well with the category's Positive keywords and thus earns CLASSICAL.

Evidence links: - Public pages showing parent-open events and parent-focused content (open houses, orientation, homeschool nights, etc.). - Lexicon signals for parents and community partner opportunities.

Aggregate assessment and overall classification

- Category scores:
- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicit Great Books / Great Conversation articulation: Publicly publish a clear Great Books framework and Great Conversation commitments, listing core works and how they thread through grades K–12, including specific Great Books for Grades 9–12 and how they connect to Virtue formation and telos. This would raise Element 3 (Curriculum) toward CLASSICAL and strengthen Element 2 (Purpose/Goal) by articulating a true telos.
- Clear articulation of the metaphysical foundations in coursework: Include explicit statements in the curriculum and syllabi about transcendental truth, goodness, and beauty, and their integration into core subjects (especially sciences, literature, and history). This would reinforce Element 1 toward CLASSICAL.
- Strengthen the living-faculty dimension: Publish a formal "Portrait of a Teacher" and explicit faculty development plan aligned with classical pedagogy (formal impressions of mentors, lifelong learners, living curriculum). This would lift Element 5 toward CLASSICAL and support Element 4 (Pedagogy) with stronger evidence of Socratic/seminar practice.
- Deepen Paideia-style pedagogy: Introduce visible Paideia-style seminars or Socratic cycles in upper grades, with public-facing samples of seminars and student-led inquiries. This would push Element 4 and Element 3 toward CLASSICAL.
- Increase explicit "formation" language in parent communications: Create a published Parent Formation program, including a book club series and liturgical-year study with practitioner notes, to strengthen Element 6 and drive cross-category alignment toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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